

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

VOLUME 3

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V. KEYS TO HANDLING A CRISIS SUCCESSFULLY:

1. Become familiar with the areas you use. Before an emergency occurs, know your evacuation routes and where to take shelter-in- place depending upon the emergency.
2. STAY CALM. Do not make the situation worse. Do not let people take foolish chances. Others will respond as you do. Set the example.
3. If you find yourself in charge of an area, delegate duties. Clearly communicate your needs and trust others to do their part. This trust will aid others who need to feel useful.
4. Use plain language during a crisis. Everyone will be under stress. Keep things simple and straightforward.
5. Be aware of those around you. Aid those people who you can without added risk. Follow instructions when they are relayed.
6. Talk to each other. Simply talking to each other and discussing what could happen and how to respond prepares us for crisis.
7. Remember personalities. Stress, fear, fatigue and anger might be present in those people around you. Be prepared to deal with human nature. Do not let it frustrate you.

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VI. PERSONNEL TRAINED IN FIRST AID/CPR:

	Name	Department	Extension
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			
7.			
8.			
9.			
10.			
11.			
12.			
13.			
14.			

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VII. LOCATION OF THE PLAN:

The Plan is available to be reviewed in:

1. The break room.
2. The offices of the:
 - Emergency Coordinator
 - All employees are given a copy of the Plan to keep at their work areas and to use when necessary.

VIII. GENERAL EMERGENCY PROCEDURES:

1. Emergency Coordinator
 - The Emergency Coordinator oversees the actions to be taken during an emergency.
2. Procedures
 - Procedures for each type of emergency are generally different. Employees are to follow the procedures as outlined in this Emergency Action Plan (the Plan) for each type of emergency.
3. Emergency Notification- How notifications are communicated.
 - For most emergencies affecting the entire facility, emergency notification is made via one of the following systems in accordance with the California Code of Regulations, Title 8, Article 165:
 - a. Fire Department
 - 1) Company Officers: Verbal announcement in each room.
4. Exits
 - When the facility is to be evacuated, employees are to exit via the nearest marked exit if there is no danger via that exit.
5. Fire Extinguisher Use
 - Unless a fire is very small, NO EMPLOYEES are to use any of the fire extinguishers located throughout the facility. This organization puts the safety of its employees first.
6. Assembly Area
 - In the event of an evacuation of the facility, all parties meet at the Assembly Area.
7. Critical Operations
 - This organization does not have any critical operations requiring shutdown prior to evacuation. Exiting the facility is the focus in the event of an emergency requiring evacuation.
8. First Aid and CPR
 - Only trained employees in first aid and/or CPR are permitted to administer such treatment.

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9. Accounting for Everyone on the Premises After an Evacuation, CCR Title 8, Section 3220(b)(3)

- a. On duty staff: in the event of an evacuation the on-duty Company Officer will make sure all fire department personnel are out of the building and will conduct a head count. The on duty, Company Officer will make sure all employees of the Fire Department office have left the building and will conduct a head count of all Fire Department employees.
- b. Visitors: Each visitor's contact person is responsible for ensuring the safe evacuation of the visitor. Contact persons inform the Emergency Coordinator of the status of their visitors.
- c. Mobility impaired: Individuals who are mobility impaired may need assistance with building evacuation and proceeding to the Assembly Area. Ask them how you can help them since oftentimes they have certain things needing to be done prior to and during assistance. In general:
- d. Ambulatory individuals are those persons with disabilities that might impair rapid building evacuation. Examples include those people who are blind or deaf, or whose mobility is restricted by the use of walkers or crutches. Guiding them to a stairwell, waiting until a clear passage is established, and helping them down the stairs to go to the Assembly Area can provide assistance for ambulatory individuals. If stairs are not involved, help them evacuate the building and assist them to get to the Assembly Area.
- e. Non-ambulatory individuals are those persons with disabilities requiring the use of wheelchairs or scooters. Help them evacuate the building and proceed to the Assembly Area.

10. All Clear

- When it is safe to re-enter the facility, the local Fire Marshal or Emergency Coordinator gives the all clear.

11. Questions

- All questions relating to the emergency action plan, including evacuation, are to be addressed to the Emergency Coordinator. CCR Title 8, Section 3220(b)(6)

IX. GENERAL EMERGENCY PROCEDURES:

1. If needed, call 911

- a. Paramedics, or
- b. Ambulance, or
- c. Fire Department

2. Provide the following information:

- a. Nature of medical emergency
- b. Location of the emergency (address plus which suite and/or room)
- c. Your name and phone number from which you are calling

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3. If needed, assistance for First Aid help:
 - a. Request assistance from someone trained in first aid from the list of trained employees.
 - b. **NO PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT:** There is no need for a general emergency notification to the rest of the employees.
4. Inform the Emergency Coordinator about the situation.
5. Not Moving a Victim: Do not move a victim unless absolutely necessary.

X. FIRE EMERGENCY PROCEDURES:

When YOU discover a fire:

DO NOT ATTEMPT TO FIGHT THE FIRE - - -

CALL FOR PROFESSIONAL HELP AND EVACUATE THE FACILITY

1. Notify the local fire department by calling: 911
2. Initiate the evacuation announcement by stating:
 - a. ***FIRE - FIRE - FIRE: PLEASE EXIT THE BUILDING AND GO DIRECTLY TO THE ASSEMBLY AREA.***
 - b. Repeat the announcement.
 - c. Complete this announcement as follows (customize by location):
 1. Voice communication
 11. Phone paging or voice communication (if phones are not working)
 111. Public Address (PA) system or voice communication (if PA is not working)
 - iv.

As an OCCUPANT of the facility:

1. Leave the building using one of the designated escape routes as shown by installed lighted exit signs and floodlights with battery-backup systems. CCR Title 8, Section 3220(b)(l)
2. Go to the Assembly Area.
3. Remain at the Assembly Area until the competent authority (the Fire Marshal or Emergency Coordinator) announces it is safe to reenter the building or leave the premises.

The Emergency Coordinator must:

1. Coordinate an orderly evacuation of all personnel.
2. Perform an accurate head count of personnel reporting to the Assembly Area.

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3. Coordinate with emergency personnel to rescue anyone who is not present in the Assembly Area.
4. Provide fire department personnel with any necessary information they may need regarding the facility.
5. Report the status to senior management.

Other Key Points:

1. In the event of a fire, getting out of the building and going to the Assembly Area is the number one step to take. In the event you cannot get out of the area where you are located, take the following steps:
 - a. If trapped in a room, retreat and close as many doors as possible between you and the fire. Place cloth material around/under the door to stop smoke from coming in. Signal from windows, but **DO NOT** break the glass unless absolutely necessary.
 - b. If forced to travel through smoke, stay low and breathe shallowly using a shirt or jacket, or other piece of cloth as a filter.
 - c. If a closed door feels hot to the touch, **DO NOT OPEN IT.**
2. Do NOT attempt to re-enter the building or leave the area until accounted for and/or instructed to do so.

XI. EARTHQUAKE EMERGENCY PROCEDURES:

Most of our earthquakes are minor. We get rolling ones and sudden jolts, but they are over either immediately or within a couple of seconds. During these minor quakes, there is no time to take any action. By the time we duck and cover the quake has ended.

On the other hand, we also have a history of earthquakes lasting much longer and have done great damage.

Since we do not know what kind of quake we are getting, it is best to be cautious. As they say, better safe than sorry.

1. If needed and if there is time, the Emergency Coordinator must ensure the following announcement is made at the time of an earthquake:
 - a. ***EARTHQUAKE - EARTHQUAKE - EARTHQUAKE: DUCK AND COVER. REMAIN IN PLACE UNTIL TOLD TO DO OTHERWISE.***
 - b. Repeat the announcement.
2. Each Employee Should:
 - a. Stay in the building. Do not run outside.

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- b. Immediately find a protective place such as under a heavy desk or table.
- c. Keep away from overhead fixtures, windows, filing cabinets, bookcases and other shelving units. Stay away from electrical power sources, if at all possible.
- d. Assist people with disabilities in finding a safe place.
- e. Evacuate as instructed by the Emergency Coordinator in charge ONLY IF directed to do so.

XII. EARTHQUAKE EMERGENCY PROCEDURES:

In the event of extended power loss, certain precautionary measures are to be taken:

The Decision to Evacuate the facility is made by top management.

Normally evacuation is not done if the power outage occurs during daylight hours, the outage is short, and no extenuating circumstances warrant an evacuation.

Evacuation is done if the power outage is determined to be lengthy in time, and/or during the hours of darkness, and/or there are some other extenuating circumstances warranting an evacuation (such as security issues). Emergency battery back-up exit lights and floodlights have a short amount of time to stay lit. Especially during the hours of darkness, the facility must be evacuated when the emergency lights start to go out.

Power Failure (OPTION#1):

ANNOUNCE

THERE HAS BEEN A POWER FAILURE. REMAIN IN PLACE UNTIL TOLD TO DO OTHERWISE. Repeat the announcement.

Power Failure (OPTION#2):

ANNOUNCE

THERE HAS BEEN A POWER FAILURE. PLEASE CALMLY EXIT THE BUILDING AND GO DIRECTLY TO THE ASSEMBLY AREA. Repeat the announcement.

Turning Off Electrical Equipment: Unnecessary electrical equipment and appliances should be turned off in the event power restoration would surge causing damage to electronics and affecting sensitive equipment. CCR Title 8, Section 3220(b)(2)

Security: Protection of people and property during a power outage is of utmost concern. If the decision is made not to evacuate, be on alert for strangers entering the facility who do not seem

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to fit. Ask if you can help them, but also be prepared to call for help from management or even law enforcement (911).

XXI. EXTENDED POWER LOSS (WITHOUT FIRE) PROCEDURES

In the event of extended power loss, certain precautionary measures are to be taken:

1. The Decision to Evacuate the facility is made by top management.
 - a. Normally evacuation is not done if the power outage occurs during daylight hours, the outage is short, and no extenuating circumstances warrant an evacuation
 - b. Evacuation is done if the power outage is determined to be lengthy in time, and/or during the hours of darkness, and/or there are some other extenuating circumstances warranting an evacuation (such as security issues). Emergency battery back-up exit lights and floodlights have a short amount of time to stay lit. Especially during the hours of darkness, the facility must be evacuated when the emergency lights start to go out.
2. Power Failure (OPTION #1):
 - a. **ANNOUNCE: THERE HAS BEEN A POWER FAILURE. REMAIN IN PLACE UNTIL TOLD TO DO OTHERWISE.**
 - b. Repeat the announcement.
3. Power Failure (OPTION#2):
 - a. **ANNOUNCE: THERE HAS BEEN A POWER FAILURE. PLEASE CALMLY EXIT THE BUILDING AND GO DIRECTLY TO THE ASSEMBLY AREA.**
 - b. Repeat the announcement.
4. Turning Off Electrical Equipment:
 - a. Unnecessary electrical equipment and appliances should be turned off in the event power restoration would surge causing damage to electronics and affecting sensitive equipment. CCR Title 8, Section 3220(b)(2)
5. Security:
 - a. Protection of people and property during a power outage is of utmost concern. If the decision is made not to evacuate, be on alert for strangers entering the facility

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who do not seem to fit. Ask if you can help them, but also be prepared to call for help from management or even law enforcement (911).

XXII. THREATS - BOMB OR BIOLOGICAL

Violence Related:

1. Normally no public announcement is made due to security issues.
2. Bomb Threat
 - a. Most bomb threats are received by telephone.
 - b. Use the Telephone Bomb Threat Checklist on the next page to record what is happening if you are the one to receive the call. Try to stay on the line with the caller for as long as you can.
 - c. If the threat is an immediate one, hang up, call 911 and initiate evacuation of the facility.
 - d. While talking to the caller, try to get the attention of someone else to call 911. Write out a sign on a piece of paper stating Bomb Threat: Call 911 so the emergency procedures can be put into action. Senior management needs to be immediately informed of what is happening.
 - e. Immediately examine your area for any unusual or unfamiliar items. DO NOT handle, move, or touch suspicious items, but report them to law enforcement.
 - f. The Emergency Coordinator or law enforcement will make a determination as to whether an evacuation is warranted based on an assessment of the threat level. If told to do so, move to a safe location, outside and far from the building if possible, and wait for directions as to what to do next.

Biological Threat:

1. Do not shake, open or empty a suspicious package.
2. Cover the package with anything available.
3. Leave the room with all other occupants, closing the door. Make a list of all people who were in the room, and anyone who was in contact with the item.
4. Immediately call 911 and as stated in the General Emergency Procedures, immediately inform senior managers such a call has been made so they are aware of the emergency situation.
5. Wash any exposed skin areas with soap and water. Remove any contaminated clothing and seal it in a plastic bag.

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XXIII. TELEPHONE BOMB THREAT CHECKLIST PROCEDURES

INSTRUCTIONS: Be Calm, Be Courteous. Listen. Do Not Interrupt the Caller.

YOUR NAME: _ _ _ _ _ TIME: _ _ _ _ _

DATE: _ _ _ _ _

CALLER'S IDENTITY: Male Female Adult Juvenile

APPROXIMATE AGE: _ _ _ _

ORIGIN OF CALL: Local _ _ _ _ _ Long Distance _ _ _ _ _

VOICE CHARACTERISTICS

SPEECH

LANGUAGE

Loud	Soft	Fast	Slow	Excellent	Good
_ High Pitch	_ Deep	Distinct	Distorted	Fair	Poor
_ Raspy	Pleasant	Stutter	Nasal	Foul	_ _ _ _ Other
Intoxicated	---	Other	Slurred	---	Other

ACCENT

MANNER

BACKGROUND NOISES

Local	Not Local	Calm	_Angry	_Factory	Trains
_Foreign	_Region	Rational	Irrational	Machines	Animals
Race		Coherent	Incoherent	Music	_ Quiet
		Deliberate	Emotional	Office	Voices
		_Righteous	_Laughing	Machines	_Airplanes
				Street	_ Party
				Traffic	_ Atmosphere

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Additional Bomb Threat Response Suggestions: Pretend difficulty in hearing - keep the caller talking - if the caller seems agreeable to further conversation, ask questions like:

When will it go off? Certain Hour _ _ _ _ _ Time Remaining _ _ _ _ _

Where is it located? Building _ _ _ _ _ Area _ _ _ _ _

What kind of bomb? _____

What kind of package? _ _ _ _ _

How do you know so much about the bomb? _____

What is your name and address? _ _ _ _ _

If the building is occupied, inform the caller detonation could cause injury or death.

Call the Emergency Coordinator at and/or 911, and relay information about the call.

Notify your supervisor immediately. When finished, think: Did the caller appear familiar with the facility (by his/her description of the bomb location)? Write out the message in its entirety and any other comments on a separate sheet of paper and attach to this checklist for use by management and law enforcement authorities.

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XXIV. OTHER WORKPLACE PROCEDURES

Violence Related:

Normally **no public announcement** is made due to security issues.

1. Gunfire/Weapons Observed:

- If gunfire is heard, seek refuge in an area that can be locked from within if possible.
 - i. Choose a room without windows or stay out of sight from the room windows.
 - ii. Barricade the doors.
 - iii. Close blinds.
 - iv. Block windows, if possible.
 - v. Turn off lights.
 - vi. Turn off radios, televisions, computer monitors and other electronic devices.
 - vii. Silence cell phones (do *not* turn them off).
 - viii. Place signs in *exterior* windows to identify the location of injured persons.
 - ix. Hide quietly and remain hidden in the room.
- b. If possible, call 911. If it is *safe* to do so, stay on the line with the dispatcher. Report the following:
 - i. Your specific location - building name and office/room number
 - ii. Number of people at your specific location
 - iii. Injuries - number injured, types of injuries.
 - iv. Assailants - location, number of suspects, race/gender, clothing description, physical features, type of weapons (long gun or handgun), backpack, shooter's identity if known, what kind of explosions and/or gunfire are happening.
- c. Take no action to intervene.
- d. Un-securing an Area: Consider risks before un-securing rooms; the shooter may still be trying to enter rooms. Oftentimes, such shooters will not stop until an outside force engages her or him.
 - i. Attempts to rescue people should only be tried if it can be accomplished without further endangering the persons inside a secure area.
 - ii. Consider the safety of those persons secured in the room versus those persons outside of the room.
 - iii. If doubt exists for the safety of the individuals inside the room, the area should remain secured.

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2. Workplace Violence Threat Report:

- In the event you were personally involved with someone making a workplace violence threat against you, or you know of such a situation, use the *Workplace Violence Threat Report* form (on the next page) to document the occurrence and notify management of the situation.

3. Hostage Situation:

- a. Immediately evacuate the building if this action does not put you in greater danger. Carefully avoid the attention of those people who are taking hostages.
- b. **Take no action to intervene.** Be alert and observe suspicious people in the area.
- c. Call 911 if possible. Be aware the 911 system will likely be overwhelmed. You may have to be patient in getting an emergency dispatcher.
- d. When you do, provide as much information as possible. If safe to do so, remain on the line with the dispatcher.

4. Weapons of Mass Destruction (WMD)

- In the event you and/or your colleagues are informed of a WMD attack, take the following actions:
 - a. Shelter in place.
 - b. Close all windows.
 - c. If possible, turn off all fans, heating and air conditioning units.
 - d. Wet some towels and jam them in the crack of the doors.
 - e. Do not use the telephone unless it is a life-threatening emergency.
 - f. If the disaster occurs near you, check for injuries. Give first aid and get help for seriously injured people.
 - g. Stay in the room and listen to the radio or television for news and instructions.
 - h. Try to be as calm as possible for yourself and for those others around you.
 1. Follow the advice of local emergency officials.

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XXV. Workplace Violence Threat Report

(Use additional sheets of paper if necessary)

Name: _____

Date: _____

Department: _____

Phone: _____

Date of Incident: _____

Time of Incident: _____

Nature of Incident (e.g., verbal threat, physical threat): _____

Describe the incident in detail: _____

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Describe any conduct by the threatening party making you believe the person intends to follow through on the threat? _____

List the names of any other witnesses to the threat or violent behavior. _____

Describe any suggestions for minimizing the risk of a violent act based on the information you have. _____

Provide any other information that will help in a review of this matter.

Signature: _____

Immediately deliver this completed form to your Company Officer, the Emergency Coordinator, or the Fire Chief/Deputy Fire Chief.

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- b. Have electrical emergency exit and floodlights tested at least annually to ensure the battery-backup devices are working.

XXVIII. IDEAS FOR THE PRESS AND MEDIA CONTACT (SOME SUGGESTIONS)

Whether dealing with a severe employee injury, a chemical release into the ground or air, a vehicle accident, a third-party liability incident, a fire, or any other problem coming to the public's attention, organizational management sometimes has to work with reporters, journalists, and other people from the news media and press.

The following are some tips from a variety of sources to assist management in its efforts to be forthright, yet careful, when communicating with news-gathering men and women. There is duplication, a good thing, since you will see where the authors see eye-to-eye on this subject and where you will want to focus your attention. There are also different takes on the subject and you will want to fit these ideas into your own style to make them work.

Rules of Engagement

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1. It's not the question - it's the answer. You never see the question on TV.
2. It's not the reporter - it's the audience you are speaking to.
3. Use and be used. They are using you, so you get to use them to get your message out.
4. They can't use what you don't say.
5. Think before you speak - there is no dead air on TV.
6. Never lie.
7. Never say "No Comment."
8. Say, "I don't know."
9. Pass them on (to other sources).
10. Be a good source.

Rules for Dealing with Reporters

Patrick Fox, President of The Saint Consulting Group, Copyright© Saint Consulting

1. Never lie.
2. Answer the calls of the press.
3. Stay on the record.
4. Always prepare for an interview.

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5. Always have an agenda.
6. Bridge to your agenda
7. Think before you speak.
8. Keep your cool.
9. Don't accept their definitions.
10. Be ambiguous only when you want to be.
11. Keep answers short when under fire.
12. Avoid jargon.

Dealing with the Press

Dan Hamilton, Copyright © 1992 Planning Commissions Journal

1. Return phone calls.
2. Be prepared.
3. Do not duck controversy.
4. Do not try to dictate a story's content or tone.
5. Cultivate a good source relationship with reporters who "get it right."
6. Alert the media to favorable stories.
7. When things go wrong:
 - a. Promptly ask for the correction of factual inaccuracies.
 - b. Ask for an appointment with the reporter.
 - c. Ask for an appointment with the editor/news director.
 - d. Alert the press to good stories.
 - e. Write letters to the editor rebutting factual errors or an unfavorable slant. Do so without adopting a defensive or complaining tone.

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Dealing with the Press

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1. Be well briefed.
2. Anticipate questions.
3. Get the answers down very carefully.
4. Rehearse.
5. List the key points.
6. Remain politely aloof and uninvolved, without fostering animosity.
7. Write out a position beforehand.
8. Minimize your comments if possible.
9. Do not go "off the record." The press does not appreciate this kind of interview because they cannot use the information.
10. Avoid "no comment." Instead, smile and say something like: "I'd like to help you, but you know it would be a violation of professional ethics (or client confidentiality) for me to discuss this subject with you." Some things are beyond your control.
11. Stay calm and try to be as rational and thoughtful as you can.

News Reporters: Friends or Foes?

Taken from a Presentation on this Subject by Tina Noel, Media & Public Relations Consultant, Copyright© Tina Noel

1. Most news reporters are just looking for the truth.
2. Few are out to get you.
3. They shape public perception.
4. All are on deadline.
5. They need accurate, reliable sources to provide information in a hurry.
6. News reporters are not your friends, and they are not your foes. They are just out to get "the news."
7. Know the audience the reporter serves. Deliver a message serving the reporter's audience.
8. If possible, don't consent to an on-the-spot interview. Take the time to prepare. Determine the reporter's deadline and meet it.
9. Listen: Make sure you know what the question is before you answer it.
10. If the reporter does not understand his or her subject matter, take the time to educate him or her.
11. Nothing is "off the record."
12. If a video camera is in the room, assume the red light is always on.
13. Never say "no comment." It makes you sound guilty.

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14. Use facts and statistics. Used appropriately, facts and statistics strengthen your message and make you look even smarter than you are. (On the other hand), make them easily understandable.
15. Avoid jargon.
16. Practice. Practice. Practice.
17. Stay on message. Don't get off track and lose your opportunity to get your message across.
18. Be direct:
 - a. Sometimes you cannot answer.
 - b. Sometimes you do not know the answer.
 - c. It is okay to say you cannot answer or do not know. Do not weasel around it. If you can find the answer, offer to do so and do it.
19. Tell the truth. Lies are not only wrong, they are too easy to disprove and you will not recover from being found out.
20. Do not speculate or lose your temper. You will end up looking silly.
21. Basic steps for all interviews:
 - a. Determine the interview topic.
 - b. Define your message.
 - c. Work within your organization to determine core messages defining what you offer the public.
 - d. Develop three bullet points/talking points succinctly expressing those core messages.
 - e. Practice. Practice. Practice.
 - f. Stay on message.
22. Interview To-Do List
 - a. Upon receiving a phone call from a reporter:
 1. Politely say you are in the middle of something and must call back.
 - n. Ask for the reporter's deadline; agree to beat it, keep your word.
 111. Ask for the reporter's name and contact information.
 - 1v. Ask: What's the interview topic?
 - v. Ask: How long will the interview last?
 - vi. Ask: Where/how will the interview take place?
 1. On the phone?
 2. In person?
 3. Live radio/TV?
 4. Taped broadcast?
23. Ask: Who else will be interviewed?

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24. If possible, determine the reporter's audience demographics:
- Size.
 - Age.
 - Gender.
 - General socio-economic issues.
 - Sympathetic to your issue?
 - Against your issue?
 - Mentioning recent events.
25. If possible, determine if the reporter has an opinion about the story. Develop a plan to get your message across regardless of the reporter's stance.
26. Develop ten questions you think will be asked.
- Include questions you don't want to answer.
 - Develop answers fitting your message.
 - 30-second sound bites.
 - Be succinct but quotable.
27. Get a friend to "interview" you to practice before you call the reporter back.
- Adjust answers, if necessary.
 - If doing a phone interview, keep answers and message points at hand.
 - Practice answering off-message questions by bridging back to your message.
28. In case you do not know when you are in Jargon Land, the following statements are considered jargon, and under each statement is what the statement really means:
- Jargon: "We utilize industry Best Practices to achieve specific strategic marketing outcomes."
- Means: "We use what works to get the job done."
- Jargon: "Our FTE is working on the RFP with EPA before leaving for the EOC."
- Means: "We are asking for help from the Environmental Protection Agency."
- Jargon: "IDEM and DNR have entered into an MOU optimizing implementation of the White River RAP."
- Means: "State agencies are teaming up to restore the river as soon as possible."
29. Asked and Answered
- Be compassionate.
 - Be clear.
 - Be concise.
 - Stay on message.

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- e. Make each answer count.
- f. Use positive words whenever possible.
 - i. "Challenge" not "problem"
 - ii. "Loss" not "death"
- g. Be courteous and polite.
- h. Answer the questions but do not elaborate beyond message points.
- i. Do not speak for anyone but yourself.
- J. Positively represent your organization.
- k. Do not take the bait to criticize.
- l. Do not comment on reports if you have not read them.
- m. Do not fill in silence.
- n. If you make a mistake, correct it as soon as possible:
 - i. Correct yourself during the interview if possible.
 - ii. If the interview has ended, call the reporter to make the correction before his or her deadline.
 - iii. You will be forgiven for the mistake but only if you save the reporter from repeating it.
- o. Difficult Questions:
 - i. Do not take it personally; it is not about you.
 - ii. Stay on message.
 - iii. If it gets hostile, politely end the interview.
- p. Bridging
 - i. Bridging is a public relations jargon word meaning getting out of a tough question without being a weasel.
 - ii. Good bridging phrases include:
 - 1. "Let's back up a bit. I think we have confused each other."
 - 2. "Let me tell you how that works."
 - 3. "I do not know about that, but what I do know is... ?"
 - 4. "Historically, that may have been the case, but today, we are focused on... "
- q. Bad bridging phrases include:
 - i. "That's a great question... " Comment: Reporters think ALL their questions are great. This bridge is over used and ineffective.
 - ii. "I am not going to answer that. All I am allowed to say is... " Comment: Never let them see you sweat.

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30. The Different Media

- a. Newspapers, trade press and web-based outlets:
 - i. Usually have at least a few hours to get the story.
 - ii. Can be in-depth.
 - iii. Information lasts forever.
- b. Radio and TV:
 - i. Short deadlines; need comments now
 - ii. Rarely more than a few seconds.
 - iii. Audio can be captured and posted online, but often is lost once aired.
- c. Radio Talk Shows - Know beforehand:
 - 1. The host's agenda.
 - 11. Whether the show is live or taped.
 - 111. Who else is going to be on the show?
 - iv. Are there going to be call-in phone calls?
- d. Television:
 - 1. TV is just radio if there are no compelling visuals.
 - 1. Offer "shooters" options (graphic clips) for the background of your interview if you have them.
 - ii. Your appearance matters.
 - 111. Check your hair and teeth before going on.
 - iv. Body language speaks loudly.
 - 1. Smile only if appropriate.
 - 2. Be serious if the situation warrants it.
 - 3. Maintain eye contact with the interviewer.
 - 4. Sit up straight.

31. Misquotes and Errors

- a. Everyone makes mistakes from time to time. Generally, errors and misquotes are misunderstandings. This is why you should have a clear message and stick to it.
- b. If you are misquoted so badly or the story is reported so erroneously that it distorts the truth call the reporter.
 - 1. Be sure you are right before you call.
 - 2. Have your message points down and stick to them.
 - 3. Calm down before you call.
 - 4. Politely and professionally discuss the matter.
 - 5. Ask for a follow-up story to correct the error.
 - 6. Be prepared to settle for a clarification or correction.
 - 7. Call the editor if the reporter does not agree with you. Repeat steps 1 through 6.

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Calimesa Fire Department

The Emergency Action Plan (the Plan) was created based upon a variety of credible resources, the reasonable availability of emergency preparedness information, and the judgment of those people who wrote and reviewed it.

The success of the Plan is dependent upon the input provided by organizational staff in identifying:

1. The types of emergencies impacting the organization.
2. The status of emergency devices.
3. The way the organization operates and what will or will not work within this setting.

Input from the Consultant included:

1. The format for the Plan.
2. The procedures on what to do in the event of the different types of emergencies.
3. What should be installed (exit signs and flood lights) to enhance evacuation?

Together sought to include as many activities as possible to create, implement and maintain a comprehensive and tailored Emergency Action Plan for the organization.

On the other hand, the customized Emergency Action Plan is not represented to be all- inclusive or an exhaustive approach for the organization. The tailored Plan is a dynamic document and is designed to be enhanced by the organization on an ongoing basis as management and its staff identifies applicable current and new laws & regulations, and business and safety-related practices pertaining to specific emergencies.

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No single approach is best for every organization. Although the Plan was customized to meet the needs of the organization at the time of the writing of the Plan, the had to decide how the Plan applied to the organization's given situation. Everything had to be weighed as to its relevancy and specificity to the organization.

For the above reasons, the City assumes no responsibility or liability for the use or implementation of the Emergency Action Plan. No warranties, whether oral or written, expressed or implied are made. Any and all implied warranties, including the implied warranty of merchantability and/or fitness for a particular purpose are excluded.

This NOTICE serves to confirm and to provide notification to the organization to which the Emergency Action Plan is given of the limitations under which the Plan has been prepared.

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The Fire Prevention Plan (the Plan) establishes those practices, and safeguards the Organization takes to:

1. Prevent fire in and around property occupied by employees.
2. Control a fire in the event one should start.

This Plan is written in accordance with the California Code of Regulations, Title 8, Section 3221, which establishes the elements required in the Plan.

These practices are intended to protect lives and property and maintain continuity of operations in accordance with the Organization's Injury & Illness Prevention Program policy stating:

No function is so critical as to justify or require a compromise of safety.

I. SCOPE:

The requirements of the Plan apply to:

- All organization employees.
- All organization facilities whether owned, rented, or otherwise occupied.

II. RESPONSIBILITIES:

The Organization commits the following resources to the development and implementation of the Plan:

1. The Calimesa Fire Department is responsible for coordinating the maintenance of facility fire prevention and suppression equipment and systems. This effort entails the maintenance of equipment and systems installed in the workplace to:
 - a. Prevent accidental ignition of flammable and combustible materials.
 - b. Suppress fires in all Organization facilities to include the annual service of all fire extinguishers and the ongoing service and testing of fire sprinkler systems.
2. The Calimesa Fire Department is responsible for providing new employees with fire prevention and suppression information via New Employee Safety Orientation and annual refresher training via unit safety meetings.
3. Captains are responsible for: